



TIPS & TRICKS



Using the Linux process task manager

Whenever the system hangs and we cannot do anything about it, we can kill that process by using the terminal and resume our work as before so that we don't need to restart our system. To do this, we must open the terminal by pressing *Ctrl + alt + T*.

Now, in the terminal, type the *top* command, which will show you all the running processes. From the output of the *top* command, note the PID (process ID number) that you want to kill. Let's suppose my Chrome browser is using up all the memory or CPU resources, forcing my computer to hang, and its PID is 1309.

Stop

Press *q* to exit the *top* command:

```
kill -9 <YOUR PID>
```

```
$kill -9 1309
```

This will kill the process that is running on PID 1309.

—Dhaval Kumar Prajapati, dhaval.daiict@gmail.com



Change the last modified/created date of a file

Ever wondered if you could change the last modified/created date of a file? Well, you can!

Consider the sample file as shown below, which was created on some arbitrary day:

```
-rw-rw-r-- 1 ec2-user ec2-user 52 Dec 17 07:37 sample
```

Now, create a new file with a *touch/vim*:

```
$touch new-file
```

The files in the directory will now look like what's shown below:

```
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 0 Jan 14 05:05 new-file
-rw-rw-r-- 1 ec2-user ec2-user 52 Dec 17 07:37 sample
```

Next, assign the last modified date of the sample to *new-file*:

```
$touch -r sample new-file
```

Voila! The date of the new file is now the same as the sample file!

```
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 0 Dec 17 07:37 new-file
-rw-rw-r-- 1 ec2-user ec2-user 52 Dec 17 07:37 sample
```

This preserves the contents of *new-file* but only changes the last modified date.

—Dheeraj Tripathi, dheeraj007tripathi@gmail.com

An interesting command in Ubuntu



Aptitude is a text based interface based on the Advanced Packaging Tool (APT) system. Many of the common package management functions, such as installation, removal and upgrade, can be performed in *Aptitude* with single-key commands, which are typically lower case letters. It can be installed by using the following command:

```
$sudo apt-get install aptitude
```

To verify, use the following:

```
$aptitude
```

Aptitude will accept the *moo* as a parameter, which executes the following funny words as an output. Shown below is an example of the same:

```
$aptitude -v moo
```

```
There really are no Easter Eggs in this program.
```

```
$aptitude -vv moo
```